

NINE EXTRAORDINARY WOMEN WERE FELICITATED FOR MAKING A DIFFERENCE.

SHRIYA PATIL SHINDE

MUMBAI | Women of Substance

Glamour and power marked the first *India Today Woman* Summit and Awards at the ITC Grand Central, Mumbai, on February 6. Sharing the honours were nine extraordinary women with one common thread—making a difference. Presenting the awards were social activist Erin Brockovich and Aroon Purie, chairman and editor-in-chief, India Today Group. Minal Vazirani, co-founder, SaffronArt, was the winner for business, while the award for science was given to Jyotsna Dhawan of the Centre for Cellular and Molecular Biology and for media to Ashvini Yardi, programming head, Colors. Writer Anuja Chauhan was given the India Today Woman as Storyteller award while actor Kareena Kapoor won in the arts category. Awards were also given out in the corporate world, sports and public service to Neelam Dhawan, managing director, HP India; Saina Nehwal, badminton player, and Rohini Nilekani, founder chairperson, Arghyam. Tessy Thomas, project director, Agni II variant, DRDO, was declared the Amway India Today Woman of the Year. Flagging off the summit, Purie noted that the “biggest change in the last decade-and-a-half has been brought about by women”. Delhi Chief Minister Sheila Dikshit, the inaugural speaker among a host of fabulous and feisty women, said: “We must remember we have steel hands inside the kid gloves.”

by Chitra Subramanyam

MANDAR DEODHAR

(TOP, FROM LEFT) CHAUHAN, DHAWAN, THOMAS, KAPOOR, YARDI AND VAZIRANI; (ABOVE) DIKSHIT

JAIPUR | Words Apart

Rajasthan Chief Minister Ashok Gehlot has fallen between two stools, backtracking over issues as far removed from each other as young love and police action. Blaming the previous BJP government for every problem—economic or social—Gehlot first

expressed his disapproval for the pubs and multiplex culture that caused boys and girls to hold hands. Following a national outcry, Gehlot had to declare his abiding respect for individual freedom, and assured cooing couples of police security at all times, not merely on Valentine's Day. Weeks after assuming office, the killing of an innocent youth in police firing during a protest against the murder of a Bahujan Samaj Party leader also left Gehlot red-faced. He had come to power citing 21 incidents of police firing and such ‘law-lessness’ of the BJP regime.

by Rohit Parihar



PURUSHOTTAM DWIVAKAR

KOLKATA | Not Right

Left Front chairman Biman Bose had to eat his words as his partymen feasted at Brigade Parade Grounds as the Front kicked off its campaign. Flouting a court order and Bose's promise to keep the grounds pristine, lakhs lit up bonfires and stoves; a cylinder burst setting a bus ablaze. Twelve men are now in jail.

by Abhijit Dasgupta

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countries from where Indians signed up for a Valentine's Day 'Pub Bharo' campaign launched by an online women's group.